Comparison

I honestly wasn't quite sure what to expect when I started this exercise. Here's what I can say for sure:

React has more setup and boilerplate code. Because both of these pages are relatively simple, that means that there's more React code for both of them. In the case of the schedule page, there's a lot more code. Having done the concert page now three times—React, Stimulus-only (for the first drafts of this book), and Hotwire—I was still surprised how little client-side code the Hotwire version required.

There's one place where React has less code, which is in actually tying value changes to update DOM elements. This happens automatically in React when the state changes, but Hotwire requires you to explicitly trigger them (except in the somewhat specialized case of Stimulus value-changed methods). There are probably cases where that update code gets too complicated to handle. This was certainly the case in my pre–Hotwire Stimulus project, though I think that the Hotwire helpers would have improved things somewhat.

Another concern that is likely not an issue in this example—but would be in a real-world example—is performance. React is designed to make its update loop efficient, whereas doing a lot of client-side updating in Hotwire might be less so. My inclination would be not to worry about this because I think it's a theoretical issue for most projects, but who knows?

Congratulations for making it all the way through this appendix *and* this book. Now all that is left is for you to go out and build something great.

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